

S T R O M E X

E X E C U T I V E K N O W L E D G E S Y S T E M

B O O K I X

IX

The Institution

Innovation · Research · Talent · Operations · The 100-Year Plan

The StromeX Editorial Bible · Edition II

AUTHORITY — CONSTITUTIONAL & STRATEGIC

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B O O K I X

The Institution

Innovation · Research · Talent · Operations · The 100-Year Plan

E X E C U T I V E S U M M A R Y

Volume IX defines StromeX as an institution rather than as a business — the parts that must outlive any product, market or founder. It establishes the innovation laboratory with its annual production targets and its kill discipline, the research institute and the independence clause that permits it to publish findings unfavourable to the company, and the measurement constitution together with the anti-metrics the group refuses to optimise. It sets the talent system from hiring through promotion, leadership development, entry programmes and performance review; the standard operating procedure library; the future-technology watch list and its adoption test; and the sustainability commitments. It closes with the 100-Year Plan, the values that must never change, and the Living Constitution Directive that governs every future addition to this corpus.

One book of ten. The corpus index and the other nine are at [docs/library/](#).

The StromeX Editorial Bible, Edition II.
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VOLUME

IX

The Institution

Innovation · Research · Talent · Operations · The 100-Year Plan

AUTHORITY

Constitutional & Strategic

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Volume IX defines StromeX as an institution rather than as a business — the parts that must outlive any product, market or founder. It establishes the innovation laboratory with its annual production targets and its kill discipline, the research institute and the independence clause that permits it to publish findings unfavourable to the company, and the measurement constitution together with the anti-metrics the group refuses to optimise. It sets the talent system from hiring through promotion, leadership development, entry programmes and performance review; the standard operating procedure library; the future-technology watch list and its adoption test; and the sustainability commitments. It closes with the 100-Year Plan, the values that must never change, and the Living Constitution Directive that governs every future addition to this corpus.

CHAPTER 1 — WHY THIS VOLUME EXISTS

Volumes I–VIII describe a company: what it sells, to whom, how it builds, where it goes, what it charges. A company of that description could be excellent and still be finished in thirty years — because companies die of the things this volume addresses: they stop inventing, they stop learning, they stop measuring honestly, they hire badly, their operations decay into tribal knowledge, and they optimise the present until they have no future.

An institution is a company that has solved for its own succession — of ideas, of people, of purpose. This volume is the difference between building a business and building something that lasts.

CHAPTER 2 — STROMEX LABS: THE INNOVATION LABORATORY

2.1 The mandate

A permanent, funded, protected department whose job is to produce things the operating divisions would never produce, because operating divisions are correctly optimised for this quarter's delivery.

Funded as a fixed percentage of revenue (Volume VIII §8.1: **35% of allocated free cash flow in Phase I, 25% in Phase II, 20% in Phase III**), never as a residual. Established formally in Phase II; run informally by the founding team throughout Phase I.

2.2 The annual production target

OUTPUT	ANNUAL TARGET	GATE TO THE NEXT STAGE
New product ideas	100	Written one-pager: problem, who has it, why us, why now
Internal experiments	50	Ideas that survive the one-pager review
Prototypes	20	Experiments that showed a real signal
Production launches	10	Prototypes with a customer willing to pay or depend on it

Table 1 — The annual production target

The funnel shape is the point: **90 of every 100 ideas are supposed to die**, and killing them fast is the department's core competence. An innovation lab with a high hit rate is not being ambitious enough.

2.3 The 100-idea discipline

The 100 ideas are generated deliberately, not opportunistically, and come from named sources so the pipeline never depends on inspiration:

SOURCE	CONTRIBUTION
Support ticket themes	What customers repeatedly cannot do
Lost-deal reasons	What we could not offer
The unused-module register	What we built that nobody wanted, and why
Field observation	What staff actually do that the software does not know about
Partner requests	What the ecosystem keeps asking for
Research Institute findings	Chapter 3
Future-technology watch	Chapter 7
Employee innovation time	§2.4
Adjacent-sector transfer	A solved problem in one ecosystem, unsolved in another
Constraint inversion	"What if bandwidth were free?" / "What if it had to work on paper?"

Table 2 — The 100-idea discipline

2.4 Employee innovation time

Every employee may direct **10% of their time** to self-chosen work that plausibly benefits StromeX. Inspired by long-standing practice at several research-led technology companies, with the failure mode of those programmes explicitly designed out:

- **Time is protected, not theoretical.** A manager who reclaims it is in breach; this is a reviewed behaviour.
- **Output is presented, not filed.** A quarterly internal showcase. Presenting a failure is a legitimate and celebrated outcome.
- **No approval needed to start.** Approval is needed to *ship*, which is a different gate.
- **Credit is individual and permanent.** Whoever had the idea is named on it, forever, in the record.
- **It is not overtime.** It comes out of the working week, not out of a life.

2.5 The kill discipline

Every experiment declares its kill criterion **before it starts**: what result would end it, and by when. An experiment without a kill criterion is not an experiment, it is a hobby with a budget.

Killed projects are documented — what we tried, what happened, what we learned, what would make us revisit it. The kill record is one of the most valuable documents the group produces, because the second person to have an idea deserves to know what happened to the first.

2.6 The innovation boundary

Labs works within the constitution. An innovation that would require amending Volume I Chapter 5 or 7 is not an innovation, it is a proposal to become a different company, and it goes through Volume I §9.1 rather than through Labs.

CHAPTER 3 — STROMEX RESEARCH INSTITUTE

3.1 Why a commercial company runs a research institute

Three reasons, and only the third is really about credibility:

1. **Our markets are genuinely under-researched.** There is very little rigorous published work on what actually works in West African education technology, on credential fraud economics, on institutional digitisation in low-bandwidth environments, or on Islamic education technology. We have data nobody else has and questions nobody else is asking.
2. **Research improves the product.** A learning-science finding about spacing and retrieval changes how the memorisation engine should work. That is a product decision that should be made from evidence rather than from intuition.
3. **Credibility with the institutions that matter.** Ministries, universities, donors and regulators take published research seriously in a way they do not take marketing seriously. A company that has published a rigorous study on examination integrity is a different kind of supplier in a tender.

3.2 Research domains

DOMAIN	EXAMPLE QUESTIONS
Artificial intelligence	How should AI assist assessment without displacing judgement? What does grounding actually reduce hallucination by, measured?
Education & learning science	What spacing schedules work for Qur'anic memorisation specifically? What predicts dropout in West African secondary schools?
Educational technology	What determines whether school software is adopted or abandoned?
FinTech	How do fee-instalment structures affect collection rates and completion rates?
Psychology & behaviour	How do institutional buyers in low-trust markets actually evaluate suppliers?
Human-computer interaction	Interface design for low digital confidence and shared devices
Digital transformation	What distinguishes institutions that transform from those that install software?
Islamic education technology	An almost entirely unstudied field where we have unusual access and obligation
Public administration technology	What makes government digital services actually get used?
Digital identity & credentials	The economics of credential fraud; what verification actually changes

Table 3 — Research domains

3.3 Research standards

Non-negotiable, because bad research published by a commercial company is worse than no research:

4. **Pre-register the question and the method.** Analysis decided after seeing the data is not a finding.
5. **Publish negative results.** A study showing our own product did not help is exactly the study that makes the positive ones credible.

6. **Never publish research that cannot survive being wrong for us.** If the finding would embarrass the company, that is a reason to publish it carefully, not a reason to bury it.
7. **Consent and ethics first.** Institutional data used in research requires informed institutional consent; children’s data requires the strictest handling (Volume IV §4.3) and in most cases should not be used at all.
8. **Anonymise and aggregate.** No institution or individual identifiable without explicit, specific, revocable permission.
9. **External review.** Serious work is reviewed by qualified people outside the company before publication.
10. **Separate research from marketing.** A white paper written to sell something is a brochure and must be labelled as one. The Institute does not produce brochures.
11. **Open access.** Published freely. Data published where consent and privacy permit.

3.4 Outputs

Peer-reviewed papers where the work merits it · practical reports for practitioners, written in plain language · open datasets where ethically permissible · annual “State of Institutional Digitisation” report for our markets · methodology and instrument publications so others can replicate · research fellowships for academics in our markets (Volume V §11.2).

3.5 The independence clause

The Research Institute may publish findings unfavourable to StromeX products, and no commercial function may block it. Suppression requires a Board decision and the fact of suppression is recorded in the corpus. This clause is what makes everything else the Institute publishes worth reading.

CHAPTER 4 — THE MEASUREMENT CONSTITUTION

4.1 The principle

Everything of consequence is measured; every measure has an owner; no measure is optimised at the expense of the thing it was meant to represent.

That last clause is the whole chapter. A metric that becomes a target stops being a good metric, and the specific ways this happens in a company like ours are predictable enough to name in advance.

4.2 The measurement domains

DOMAIN	PRIMARY MEASURES	OWNER
Customer satisfaction	Would-recommend, CSAT after support, adoption rate, value-ledger trend	Customer Success
Feature usage	Active use by module, unused-module register, workflow completion	Product
Revenue	By engine, by ecosystem, by geography, by tier	Finance
Profitability	Gross margin vs. band per division, contribution per customer segment	Finance
Retention	GRR, NRR, logo churn with real reasons, cohort curves	Customer Success
Support quality	First response, resolution, reopen rate, ticket themes	Support
Employee	Retention, internal mobility, time-to-productivity, engagement	People
Reliability	Uptime, error rate, latency percentiles, SLA credits applied	Engineering
Security	Incidents by severity, time to patch, access-review completion, pen-test findings	Security
Marketing	Organic traffic, ranked terms, referral share, verification-page sessions	Marketing
Conversion	Free→identified→qualified→customer, by channel and cohort	Growth
Delivery	Time to first value, go-lives requiring heroics, implementation margin	Delivery
Innovation	Ideas→experiments→prototypes→launches, kill-rate, time-to-kill	Labs
Ethics & integrity	Ethics reviews, refusals, integrity losses, prohibited-practice reports	Executive

Table 4 — The measurement domains

4.3 The named anti-metrics

Measures we track but explicitly refuse to optimise, with the reason each would corrupt:

ANTI-METRIC	WHY WE REFUSE
Bookings without adoption	Manufactures a good quarter out of a bad year (Volume V §12.5)
Support ticket volume (minimised)	Punishes customers for asking and hides product defects
Time on app	We are not an attention business (Volume I §14.3)
Headcount	A cost, not an achievement (Volume I §14.5)
Lines of code / tickets closed	Measures motion, not value
Free-tier signups (as a headline)	Trivially inflatable and disconnected from value delivered
Valuation	Volume VIII §5 — not controllable, and optimising for it corrupts everything upstream
Any customer metric the customer would dispute	If they would not recognise the number as true, it is not true

Table 5 — The named anti-metrics

4.4 Reporting honesty

Every metric reported with its **denominator**, its **period**, and its **trend** — never a bare number · bad quarters reported as prominently as good ones · a metric definition may not be changed without restating history and saying that it was changed · **when a target is missed, the plan changes, not the measurement** (Volume VIII §13).

CHAPTER 5 — THE TALENT SYSTEM

5.1 The hiring philosophy

Hire for judgement. Skills are teachable at pace; judgement is not (Volume I §13.1.8). The most predictive interview question in this company is “*tell me about a decision you got wrong, and what you changed.*” A candidate who cannot answer it either has not made decisions or has not examined them.

5.2 The hiring standard

RULE	REASON
Structured interviews, same questions, scored against a rubric	Unstructured interviews measure similarity to the interviewer
Work sample over whiteboard puzzle	Predicts the job; puzzles predict puzzle skill
Paid work samples above 2 hours	Unpaid extended work is an unfair transfer from candidate to company
At least one interviewer from outside the hiring team	Prevents team-shaped hiring
Reference checks actually made	Not a formality
No hiring on urgency	The wrong hire costs more than the vacancy — and this rule will be tested every time
Compensation benchmarked against remote-work rates, not local rates	Volume II R13: our competitors for talent are overseas employers, and pretending otherwise loses people
Written offer, no exploding deadlines	Pressure tactics in hiring predict pressure tactics in management

Table 6 — The hiring standard

5.3 The promotion framework

Promotion recognises demonstrated operation at the next level, not tenure, proximity or advocacy.

LEVEL	INDIVIDUAL CONTRIBUTOR	MANAGEMENT
1 — Learning	Executes defined work with support	—
2 — Contributing	Owens defined work independently	—
3 — Owning	Owens an area; others build on their work	Leads a small team
4 — Leading	Sets direction for an area; multiplies others	Leads a function
5 — Shaping	Changes how the company works; judgement trusted under uncertainty	Leads a division
6 — Institutional	Work outlives their tenure; the company is different because they were here	Executive

Table 7 — The promotion framework

Both tracks are equal at every level, in title, in compensation and in influence. A company where the only path upward is management loses its best engineers, designers and editors to management, where they are frequently worse and always scarcer.

The Volume I §13.3 criteria govern: judgement under uncertainty · work others build on · customers who ask for them by name · documents that outlive the project · mistakes surfaced early and learned from publicly · colleagues who are better for working alongside them.

5.4 Leadership development

Managers are trained before they manage, not after they struggle · every manager has a manager who reviews their team's retention and growth, not only their output · management is a **role, not a rank** — moving out of management is a lateral move, and is treated and paid as one · leadership candidates are identified two levels down and developed deliberately · **succession plans exist for every executive role from Phase II**, including the founder's (Volume VIII Gate I, criterion 10).

5.5 Entry programmes

PROGRAMME	SHAPE	PURPOSE
Graduate programme	18 months, three rotations, mentor, guaranteed role on completion	Build the next decade's leadership from our own markets
Internship	3–6 months, paid, real work, named mentor	Pipeline; never unpaid, never coffee-fetching
Apprenticeship	24 months, no degree required, structured curriculum	Talent that the credential system missed — of which our markets have an enormous amount
Returnship	6 months, for people re-entering after a career break	An under-recruited pool, disproportionately women
Campus & student ambassadors	Part-time, at institutions we serve	Volume V §11.2

Table 8 — Entry programmes

The apprenticeship deserves emphasis. A company whose entire business is that credentials should be verifiable and that institutions should be measured on outcomes cannot then hire exclusively on the basis of degrees. Building a genuine non-graduate path is both consistent and commercially smart, because that talent is available and under-competed.

5.6 Continuous learning

An annual learning budget per employee, defended · internal teaching expected at level 3 and above, because teaching is how understanding is verified · conference attendance with an obligation to report back · StromeX Academy certifications free to employees · **explicit time for learning, protected the same way innovation time is.**

5.7 Performance review

Twice yearly, no forced ranking, no stack ranking · self-assessment first, then manager, then calibration across managers to check for bias · **feedback is continuous and the review contains no surprises** — a review that surprises someone is a management failure, not an employee failure · compensation reviewed separately from development, because merging them makes honest development conversations impossible · underperformance is addressed early, specifically, with support and a clear standard, and if it does not resolve, quickly and with dignity.

5.8 The mentorship system

Every new employee has a mentor outside their reporting line from week one · mentors are trained and their contribution counts toward promotion · reverse mentoring from Phase II, where junior employees mentor executives on what the company actually feels like from below — which is information that otherwise never reaches the top of any organisation.

5.9 The culture protections

Sustainable pace enforced by managers, not by policy documents (Volume I §13.1.9) · bad news travels fastest and is rewarded, always (§13.1.4) · dissent recorded and preserved (§9.3) · concealment is the one issue that is not coached · **no one is indispensable, and anyone who has become indispensable is a risk we created and must fix.**

CHAPTER 6 — OPERATIONAL EXCELLENCE & THE SOP LIBRARY

6.1 The principle

Anything done more than three times is documented; anything documented and stable is automated.

This is not bureaucracy. It is the mechanism by which a company scales without its quality depending on who happens to be doing the work — and it is the mechanism by which we can credibly sell automation to institutions, because we are our own first customer.

6.2 The SOP library

Every function maintains standard operating procedures with an owner, a version, a review date, and a named escalation path.

FUNCTION	SOPS INCLUDE
Product development	Discovery · specification · design review · build · Volume IV §18.2 definition of done · release · post-launch review
Quality assurance	Test strategy · regression suites · the mandatory suites that may never be skipped · accessibility · performance · security testing · UAT with the customer
Design	Brief · research · concept · review gates · handover · asset licensing (Volume VI §9)
Customer support	Triage · severity classification · escalation · resolution · post-resolution follow-up · pattern reporting to product
Sales	Qualification · discovery (the seven questions) · proposal · pricing authority · contract · handover to delivery
Delivery	Kick-off · data readiness · migration · parallel run · training · go-live · hypercare · handover to success
Finance	Invoicing · collections · reconciliation · approvals · procurement · expense · payroll · month-end · reporting
Procurement	Requisition · quotes · supplier due diligence · approval · receipt · payment
HR	Requisition · interview · offer · onboarding · probation · review · promotion · grievance · exit
Legal	Contract review · IP · disputes · regulatory filings · data agreements · export/sanctions screening
Security	Access provisioning and review · vulnerability handling · incident response (Volume IV §17) · penetration testing · third-party assessment
Creative	Volume VI §13 quality gates
Partner	Onboarding · certification · deal registration · dispute resolution · termination

Table 9 — The SOP library

6.3 The SOP discipline

An SOP that has not been reviewed in 12 months is flagged · an SOP nobody follows is either wrong or unnecessary, and both are fixed rather than enforced · **the person who does the work owns the SOP**, not a process department · every SOP states what to do when the SOP does not fit, because a procedure with no exception path produces either paralysis or quiet non-compliance.

6.4 The internal automation mandate

The group automates its own operations first, and the reason is not efficiency — it is credibility and product truth. Every automation we sell should be one we run. An automation pack we would not use on ourselves is one we should not sell.

Priority order for internal automation: onboarding and offboarding · invoicing and collections · procurement approvals · reporting assembly · support triage · deployment and release · access provisioning and review · SOP compliance checks.

CHAPTER 7 — FUTURE TECHNOLOGIES

7.1 The evaluation doctrine

We adopt a technology when it creates measurable customer value, not when it becomes fashionable. The rolling watch list below is reviewed half-yearly by Labs and the CTO. Each entry carries a posture, and postures change on evidence.

POSTURE	MEANING
Deploy	In production, generating value
Build	Actively building
Pilot	Testing with real customers
Watch	Monitored; not invested in
Decline	Assessed and rejected, with a stated reason and a revisit condition

Table 10 — The evaluation doctrine

7.2 The watch list

TECHNOLOGY	POSTURE	ASSESSMENT
Applied AI / LLM agents	Deploy	Core to the group. Provider-independent by architecture (Volume IV §7.1)
Retrieval & knowledge grounding	Deploy	The mechanism by which AI becomes trustworthy in an institutional context
On-device / small models	Build	Directly serves the low-bandwidth, low-cost mandate. Strategically important, not merely interesting
Speech (ASR/TTS) & voice agents	Deploy	High value in low-literacy and multilingual contexts
Digital identity & verifiable credentials	Deploy	Volume IV §5. The group's strategic core
Quantum-safe cryptography	Build	Prioritised for credential signatures. A certificate signed in 2027 may need to verify in 2067; it is the group's longest-lived cryptographic commitment and therefore the first thing to migrate, ahead of transport security
IoT & sensor networks	Deploy	Smart campus, facilities, agriculture
Advanced analytics & forecasting	Deploy	Volume III Division 9
Offline-first & sync architectures	Deploy	Not a future technology in our markets — a present requirement
Robotics	Watch	Real value in manufacturing and

TECHNOLOGY	POSTURE	ASSESSMENT
		logistics (Wave 3). No customer value in education worth the cost today
Spatial computing / AR/VR	Watch	Genuine potential for laboratory simulation and vocational training; blocked on device cost in our markets. Revisit when a capable headset costs under \$150
Autonomous agents (multi-step, unsupervised)	Pilot	Constrained by Volume IV §8.1. Useful for low-stakes internal work; not for institutional decisions
Satellite connectivity	Watch	Could materially change the rural-institution proposition. Revisit on cost per Mbps in our markets
Mesh networking	Watch	Interesting for campus and emergency scenarios; unproven at institutional scale
Blockchain / distributed ledger	Pilot (narrow)	One legitimate use only: optional credential anchoring (Volume IV §5.5, layer 5), because it makes credentials verifiable independent of our continued existence. Every other proposed use in our sectors has a simpler, cheaper, better answer, and we say so plainly
Digital twins	Watch	Facilities and manufacturing, Wave 3
Wearables	Watch	Limited institutional value today
Brain-computer interfaces	Decline	No credible institutional application; profound ethical exposure. Revisit condition: none currently foreseeable
Emotion recognition / affect detection	Decline, permanently	Scientifically contested, discriminatory in practice, and its obvious application — monitoring students and employees — is precisely the surveillance we refuse (Volume I §7.4). This is a values decision, not a technical one, and it does not have a revisit condition

Table 11 — The watch list

7.3 The adoption test

Before any watch-list technology moves to Pilot: what customer problem does it solve, in the customer's words? · what does the customer currently do instead, and why is that worse? · what does it cost to deploy in our markets, on our customers' devices and connections? · what does it cost if it fails? · what would make us abandon it? · does it comply with Volume I Chapter 7?

A technology that passes every question except the last does not get adopted.

CHAPTER 8 — SUSTAINABILITY & SOCIAL COMMITMENT

Commitments, not aspirations. Each has a measure and an owner, because a sustainability chapter without measures is a marketing document.

8.1 Environmental

COMMITMENT	MEASURE
Efficiency as a design property	Performance budgets (Volume IV §10.1) reduce compute, bandwidth and device energy simultaneously — the low-bandwidth mandate is also our largest environmental lever
Renewable-powered infrastructure where available	% of compute on renewable-powered regions, published
Hardware lifecycle responsibility	Take-back and recycling for hardware we supply (Volume III §11.5); refurbishment offered before replacement
Reduce shipping impact	Print locally where quality permits (Volume VI §10.2) — which is also the cheaper and better advice
Measure before claiming	We publish our footprint before we make any claim about reducing it, and we make no carbon-neutrality claim we cannot substantiate

Table 12 — Environmental

8.2 Digital inclusion

Low-bandwidth and low-spec support as an architectural requirement, not a charitable feature (Volume IV §10) · USSD and feature-phone access where the population requires it (Volume III Division 8) · offline-first everywhere · the free tier as genuine infrastructure for institutions that will never pay · **free credential verification forever** (Volume I §5.3) · pricing bands that reflect purchasing power rather than extracting from it (Volume I §6.4).

8.3 Accessibility

WCAG 2.2 AA as the enforced floor, AAA for body text where achievable, verified in CI (Volume IV §11.1) · every product usable by keyboard and screen reader · accessibility audits free for anyone who asks (Volume III §1.5) · the design system open-sourced so accessibility benefits beyond our customers · **accessibility never a paid tier.**

8.4 Ethical AI

The Volume I §7.2 honesty rules · the Volume IV §8.1 stakes ladder · the Volume IV §9 data rights, including the refusal to train third-party models on customer data · the Volume I §7.1 workforce commitment, with free redeployment training where our automation changed someone's role · **and the standing refusal to build emotion recognition or surveillance systems** (Chapter 7.2).

8.5 Community

PROGRAMME	COMMITMENT
Scholarships	Funded places on StromeX Academy certifications for students and

PROGRAMME	COMMITMENT
	teachers who cannot pay
Free tier for low-fee schools	Standing policy discount up to 40% (Volume III §0.4); free tier without limit for schools below a fee threshold
Open source	Design system, SDKs, exporters, typography toolkit — permanently free (Volume I §5.5)
Educational outreach	Free curriculum, policy and assessment resources for any institution, customer or not
Apprenticeships	A genuine non-graduate path into technology careers (Chapter 5.5)
Research	Published openly, including findings unfavourable to us (Chapter 3.5)
Local employment	Build teams in the markets we serve, at rates benchmarked internationally, not locally

Table 13 — Community

8.6 The honesty clause

We will not publish a sustainability claim we cannot evidence, will not describe a commercial decision as a social one, and will not count the free tier as philanthropy when it is also a distribution strategy — it is both, and saying so is more credible than pretending it is only the first.

CHAPTER 9 — THE 100-YEAR PLAN

The final strategic chapter of the corpus. Written for people not yet born, who will work at a company whose founders they never met.

9.1 What StromeX should stand for after 100 years

That institutions serving ordinary people deserve extraordinary tools — and that where you were born should not determine the quality of the systems that shape your life.

If StromeX exists in 2127 and that sentence is still true of it, the company will have succeeded regardless of its size, its share price, or whether anyone remembers who started it.

9.2 The values that must never change

These are the entrenched provisions (Volume I §9.1). Amending any of them requires a Board supermajority, a published rationale and thirty days' notice — and any future leadership that finds them inconvenient should understand that the inconvenience is the point.

- 12. Verification is free for the verifier, forever.** A person's credential belongs to them. Checking it must never have a price, and a graduate's degree is never held hostage to their institution's subscription.
- 13. Customer data belongs to the customer.** Never sold, never brokered, never used to train third-party models, always exportable, free and complete.
- 14. Children's data receives the strictest handling in the group** — never monetised, never profiled, never advertised against.
- 15. No bribery, ever, in any market, for any contract.** Losing business for this reason is a correct outcome.
- 16. We do not build surveillance, weapons, or systems designed to persecute.**
- 17. High-stakes decisions about a person are made by a person,** and that person is named and accountable.
- 18. We disclose our failures before we are asked,** with a timeline and a fix.
- 19. The free tier is real,** and the boundary of what is free is stated plainly rather than discovered at the moment of frustration.
- 20. We do not sell what we cannot deliver.**
- 21. A price is honoured for its term,** and increases are announced, capped and explained.

9.3 The things that may and should change

Products. Markets. Technologies. Business models. Organisational structure. Pricing. The sectors we serve. The countries we operate in. The people who lead. **All of it should change, repeatedly, and a future leadership that preserves any of it out of reverence has misunderstood this document.** The corpus is a constitution, not a museum.

9.4 The four generational transitions

ERA	THE TRANSITION	THE RISK IT CARRIES
Years 1-20 (2027-2046)	Founder-led → institution-led	The founder never becomes dispensable, and the company ends

ERA	THE TRANSITION	THE RISK IT CARRIES
		when they do
Years 20-40	First professional leadership; the founding generation departs	The constitution is treated as the founder's preferences rather than as law, and is quietly abandoned
Years 40-70	Second and third leaderships; the founding markets mature	Success produces the complacency that makes the company a Class 2 incumbent — the very thing Volume II §5.1 describes us beating
Years 70-100	The company outlives its original technologies entirely	Nobody remembers why the entrenched provisions exist, and the reasoning was never written down

Table 14 — The four generational transitions

The mitigation for all four is the same, and it is this corpus. Not because a document has authority on its own, but because the reasoning is written down — and a future employee who disagrees can at least argue with the argument rather than guess at it. That is why Volume I §9.2 requires every amendment to state what becomes false if it is wrong, and why §9.3 preserves dissent permanently.

9.5 The legacy, stated concretely

In education: that a child in Ikorodu, Kano, Kumasi or Karachi learns in an institution whose systems are as good as any in London — and whose certificate is believed anywhere in the world without a phone call.

In technology: that the industry has a working example of a company built in an emerging market, to a global standard, without pretending to be from somewhere else, and without extracting from the people it served.

In society: that the millions of hours of administrative labour StromeX automated were returned to teaching, to care, to scholarship and to family — and that the people whose jobs changed were trained, redeployed and better off, because the company that automated their tasks took responsibility for it.

9.6 The final instruction

If StromeX ever has to choose between being large and being trusted, it chooses trusted.

That choice will present itself. It will be expensive. It will be argued for persuasively by intelligent people with good intentions and a real business case. The answer is in this line, and it was written down in 2026 precisely so that whoever faces it does not have to decide alone.

CHAPTER 10 — THE LIVING CONSTITUTION DIRECTIVE

Permanent standing instruction, applying to every author of this corpus — human or AI — in perpetuity.

10.1 The directive

Do not treat this Editorial Bible as a finished document. Treat it as a living constitution.

Whenever you identify a missing capability, governance principle, product category, revenue model, technology, operational process, or strategic opportunity that aligns with StromeX's mission and long-term sustainability, propose and incorporate it with clear justification.

Distinguish evidence-based recommendations from aspirational ideas. Preserve internal consistency. Ensure every addition strengthens the company over decades rather than optimising for short-term gains.

10.2 The authorship standard

Every addition to this corpus, by anyone, must meet the same bar the corpus holds itself to:

Answer the five questions (Volume VIII §8.3): why is this included · what measurable value does it create · what risks does it introduce · what assumptions underpin it · how will success be measured.

Separate evidence from inference, explicitly. The corpus uses three registers and marks which is which:

REGISTER	MEANING	HOW IT APPEARS
Verified	Sourced, dated, and linked	Cited inline with a source
Synthesis	Well-established industry practice, reasoned from	Stated as practice, not as a finding
Judgement	Our reasoning from first principles	Stated as our position, with the reasoning exposed so it can be attacked
Projection	Estimates about the future	Labelled, with assumptions inline and scenarios where material

Table 15 — The authorship standard

Never fabricate. No invented statistics, no fictional interviews, no imaginary case studies, no synthetic quotes, no citations that do not resolve. Where the corpus needs a number it does not have, it says so and states the method by which the number should be obtained (Volume II §2.2 is the model).

Compare before recommending. State the alternatives considered and the trade-off accepted. A recommendation with no stated alternative is an assertion.

Do not inflate. Where forecasts are given, give conservative, expected and optimistic scenarios with their assumptions, and state which one the company should plan against (Volume VIII §5).

Preserve consistency. An addition that contradicts an existing chapter must either reconcile with it or amend it explicitly under Volume I §9. Silent contradiction is the mechanism by which constitutions become decoration.

Write for the reader who was not there. The person consulting this corpus in 2043 does not know what was obvious in 2027. Write the reasoning down, not just the conclusion.

10.3 The review obligation

Every volume carries a review date. An unreviewed chapter may not be cited as authority in a dispute (Volume I §9.2.5). A chapter unamended for twelve months is flagged for review — not because it is necessarily wrong, but because a constitution nobody has questioned in a year is a constitution nobody is reading.

Glossary

Terms are defined as this corpus uses them. Where a term also has a general industry meaning, the definition here governs internally and the cross-reference points to the chapter in which the term is established.

TERM	DEFINITION
ACV	Annual contract value. The recurring revenue a customer contributes in a year, excluding one-time implementation and build fees.
Band A / B / C	The three regional price bands defined in Volume I §6.4. All catalogue prices are quoted at Band C (list); Band A applies a 0.32× multiplier and Band B a 0.65×. The band follows the institution's operating jurisdiction, not its billing address.
CAC	Customer acquisition cost. Loaded sales and marketing cost divided by customers acquired in the period.
CAC payback	The number of months of gross profit from a customer required to recover that customer's acquisition cost.
Craft standard	The requirement in Volume VI §2.1 that creative work be indistinguishable from that of a good London or New York studio while remaining reproducible by a regional printer on the first attempt.
Credential	Any institution-issued, cryptographically signed record of an award, qualification, identity or transaction that a third party may need to verify. The subject of Volume IV, Chapter 5.
Degraded mode	The defined, designed and tested behaviour of a surface under failure — no network, slow network, provider outage. Required of every surface by Volume IV §10.2.
Ecosystem	A complete sector solution spanning all eight architectural layers, rather than a product sold into a sector. The unit of strategic expansion; see Volume I, Chapter 2.
Entrenched provision	A clause amendable only by board supermajority with published rationale and thirty days' notice. Enumerated in Volume IX §9.2.
Federation	Server-to-server interoperation across independently operated instances, allowing an institution to own its data while remaining reachable. The basis of the SpaceTalk government strategy; Volume X, Chapter 5.
Foundation tier	The permanently free tier. Not a trial and not a demo; governed by the Free Constitution in Volume I, Chapter 5.
Gate	A set of conditions that must be met before a roadmap phase may end. A phase ends when its gate is passed, not when its years elapse. Volume VIII, Chapter 2.
GRR	Gross revenue retention. Recurring revenue retained from existing customers excluding expansion; measures churn alone.
Guilloche	Fine mathematical line-work used in security printing, extremely difficult to reproduce by scan-and-print. The primary visual security element of a StromeX credential; Volume VI §6.2.
Human-in-the-loop	The requirement that a named human decides, and is recorded as deciding, wherever the stakes ladder classifies a decision as high. Volume IV §8.1.
LTV	Lifetime value. The discounted gross profit expected from a customer over the expected life of the relationship.

TERM	DEFINITION
No-fork rule	The prohibition on forking shared platform layers for a single customer without written CTO approval and a sunset date. Volume IV §3.2.
NRR	Net revenue retention. Recurring revenue from existing customers including expansion and contraction. Above 100% means the existing base grows without new customers.
Pricing Council	The standing body that owns Volume III, meets quarterly, and reviews every price against delivered margin. Volume I §8.4.
Reference Implementation	A delivered institutional deployment used as proof of method and as a permanent sales asset. Four are recorded in this edition.
Rule of 40	Revenue growth percentage plus operating margin percentage. A common composite measure of whether a software company balances growth against profitability.
Stakes ladder	The four-level classification — low, medium, high, prohibited — determining how much autonomy an AI system may exercise over a decision. Volume IV §8.1.
System of record	The authoritative store of an institution's people, money, documents, credentials and decisions. Identified in Volume II §9 as the group's only genuinely durable moat.
Value ledger	The running, honest account of what an institution has gained from StromeX, shown at every renewal including the periods where the numbers are unimpressive. Volume I §4.4.
Verification token	A prepaid unit purchased by an institution for verification-adjacent services carrying real marginal cost. Verification itself is always free to the verifier. Volume III §3.5.
Wave	A group of industry ecosystems opened in the same roadmap phase. Volume I §2.2.

Table 16 — Glossary of terms

References & Bibliography

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Internal sources

Claims in this corpus about what the group has built trace to these. Catalogue lines in Volume III are marked built, partial or specified-not-built on this basis.

StromeX MVP · [apps/api](#), [apps/web](#), [infra](#)

FastAPI backend with multi-provider AI routing, memory, spaced-repetition tutor and PDF export; Next.js frontend; Docker Compose infrastructure. Establishes the canonical stack in Volume IV §2.2.

Independent MVP Audit · [docs/04-STROMEX-INDEPENDENT-AUDIT.md](#)

Security, scalability, reliability and performance audit including a critical server-side request forgery vulnerability found, reproduced and fixed. Carried forward as a standing engineering rule in Volume IV §15.

Reference Implementation №1 · [Sultan Hanafi Royal Schools](#)

Four-language institutional build (English, Arabic RTL, Yorùbá, French) with approximately thirty-five page templates per locale; four verification surfaces; certificate generation with documented identifier architecture, security model and signing-key deployment; digital identity and card system; finance platform; eight role portals; personalisation centre; and approximately one hundred and twenty institutional system, governance and design documents.

Reference Implementation №2 · [WorldWide English College](#)

A seventy-three-table credential and commerce schema across fifteen migrations, covering enrolment integrity, competencies, evidence, awards, credential signing, issued documents, verifying institutions, payments, instalment plans, multi-currency routing, corporate seats and alumni chapters. The evidential basis for Volume IV §4.2.

Reference Implementation №3 · [Al-Madeenah College](#)

Bilingual static build system with offline service worker, verification surfaces, font subsetting pipeline and document generation to PDF and DOCX.

Reference Implementation №4 · [Institutional portal system](#)

Multi-role portal implementation covering student, staff, parent, applicant and administrative roles, admissions pipeline, attendance, timetable, assessment, finance and library.

Index

Generated by the build. Page references point to where each concept is established or substantively discussed; passing mentions are not indexed. Word index markers are also embedded throughout the corpus, so a live index can be built in Word if preferred.

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Colophon

This edition is composed for A4 at 210 × 297 mm. Display matter is set in a serif book face and running text in a companion serif, with a sans for tables, captions and navigation and a monospaced face for code and architecture figures — the four typographic roles defined in Volume I, Chapter 10. The StromeX brand faces, **Archivo** and **Fraunces**, ship with this edition in [docs/bible/publication/fonts/](#); the build selects them automatically wherever they are installed in the rendering environment, so the corpus can be reissued in full brand typography without editing a line of it.

The rules, tables and figures follow the design laws in Volume I, Chapter 12: typography carries the interface, space is a component, colour carries meaning, and structural devices encode something true about the content rather than decorating it. Tables use horizontal rules only; the vertical grid is carried by alignment, as it is in every well-set financial document.

This DOCX is the authoritative master. The press-quality PDF edition is generated from it and is content-identical. Both are produced from the markdown corpus of record under version control at [docs/bible/](#), by the build recorded at [docs/bible/publication/](#), so that the publication can be regenerated exactly whenever the corpus is amended.

THE STROME X EDITORIAL BIBLE · Edition II ·
VERSION 2.0

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